

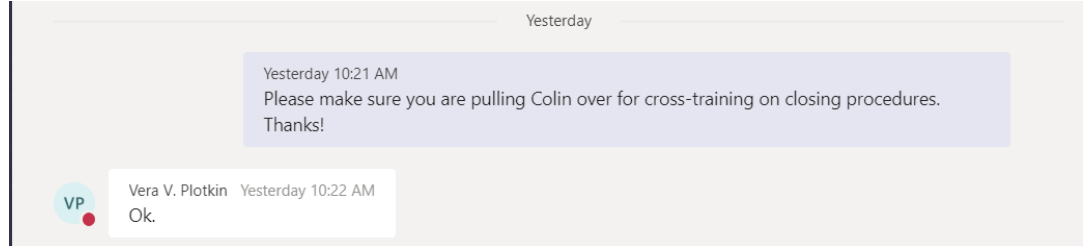
March 1, 2020

RE: Vera Plotkin Performance

2/24/20	• Due to the fact Vera didn't have the payroll reports until after the month of Jan closed, she made a few shortcuts with the JE entries, which we agreed were okay, in order to close Jan timely. ○ Once I started preparing my variance report there were several errors, well beyond the "short cuts". I spent a significant amount of time reconciling and correcting her entries. ○ Several transactions in the bank statement for \$1,120.80 – in and out at the beginning of the month, and then a withdrawal of the same amount on 1/23. We shouldn't have been charged this amount (still working with ADP to correct) and she didn't question this transaction.
2/27/20	• While I was reconciling the bank statements from Jan it was discovered: ○ \$80 transaction that was on the Jan bank statement was not recorded in the system. She had this transition in her Daily Cash Report, she prepared a JE in the month JE file, which was approved. She never entered it into Inform. • Petty cash for Rochester: ○ She had calculation errors – she told Stephen they were short, then went back and re-added – they were not short. ○ When she handed me the report to review and approve, she transposed numbers (\$126 instead of \$162) ○ Stephen commented she has YET to reconcile petty cash without making errors, which takes up his time helping to work out. • Check run for the week: ○ She included invoices in folder to be paid but were not on the report to pay – they needed to be paid that week. ○ After running the checks had the incorrect invoice clipped to a check
2/28/20	• Mike came into my office in the afternoon to tell me he was upset that Vera continues to "talk down to him" ○ According to Mike: Since Colin's car was getting work done, Mike offered to pick up the check from our customer, head to lunch, and then would be back in the office. He was planning on leaving at 11:30ish. Vera asked when he was going to be back, he replied by 1pm. She replied, "I guess I'm not leaving the office then today!" According to Mike she snapped this reply at him. 1pm is usually the time Vera takes lunch. ○ Colin came in my office when he heard Mike telling this story. He said her response was "odd" and agreed with Mike on the abruptness of it. He also added that yesterday she was questioning him about why I was giving him a bank rec to do. She was also questioning me via Teams on 2/27 if there was something wrong with cash, I reminded her I told her a week ago I was going to start reconciling the bank statements (more on that below). ○ This is the third time Mike has come to me about Vera's attitude towards him since I started. Each complaint has been how she has spoken to/treated him. • During our Friday morning huddle, I mentioned I was hopefully wrapping up the Jan bank recs and there would be some adjusting entries for her.

	○ Vera asked what they were, I said well I know of one which is was \$48.20 and had Colin check back to 2018 and we can see it was an entry that should have been cleaned up at year end way back when and we will clean it up this year. She said she knew what that was, I said excellent, you will have a correcting entry as soon as I finish this so we can get cash cleaned up. ○ She then made several comments about she wanted to be kept in the loop because she isn't always, which I said once I am finished with the recs, I would go over everything with her. ○ Later that afternoon when she came back from lunch, she brought several transactions in to show me what the \$48.20 was. I said thank you but didn't need this as we are writing it off because Rob should have cleaned it up back in 2016 at year end. ○ She then started to show me several others, I stopped her and said until I finish all these, I don't need this information. ○ Vera then started crying and said "Well I want to show you I know this because you and Colin are taking this away from me" ○ I closed my door, handed her a tissue, and reminded her again that I told her I was taking over the monthly bank recs because I was trying to segregate duties and get us caught up on recs. ○ She then started talking about how Rob threw her under the bus as well as a few other things he had done. Vera and I have been over the fact that I'm very sorry that she and Rob didn't get along, and while I wasn't minimizing her feelings, I needed her to try and put that behind her so we can keep moving forward. This continues to be a <u>very</u> disruptive issue. She has been in my office several times venting about Rob and starts to cry. While I try to be empathic to my team, this has resulted in a <u>lot</u> of time spent and is disruptive to hers and the rest of the team's work. ○ I told her no one is taking her work from her these monthly bank recs haven't even been done consistently for quite some time. I also remind her I have been discussing since Colin started, we were going to shift some duties around. ○ She continued to complain about how she told Rob to clean up these amounts and he just "threw her under the bus to Ken". I said again I was sorry for whatever happened with them, but at this point I just want to get the amount cleared up. ○ I also mentioned that while I appreciate her wanting to help, I didn't ask for this information and it took time away from items she should be working on, that I was disappointed in her actions this week (i.e. questioning Colin), and that she has been make a lot of mistakes lately. I asked her to please focus on her work and improve accuracy.
3/2/20 - 3/11/20	● Cross-training was discussed at the Friday morning huddle on 2/28. Vera was asked to start cross training with Colin on closing procedures and to pull him over when she is working on anything to do with close and we would start cross-training on other duties later. ○ She didn't work with him at all on Friday. Colin was out of the office on Monday. ○ I asked her late this morning (3/2) if she has worked with him yet because she started working on close Friday. She paused for a bit and then said no hasn't and that she was working on the payroll entries anyway. I said those are part of close and he can see those entries (they are summary level) so I asked her again to please work with him.

- As of the morning (3/4) she still hasn't cross trained Colin on any closing procedures. (Teams IM below)



- 3/5 - I asked her again if she had worked with Colin yet, she said she told him about something yesterday, but hasn't sat with him. I told her that needed to happen today, we were four days into close.
- Vera spent about an hour with Colin and hasn't spent time with him since. I mentioned to her in our 1x1 on 3/11 that she needs to spend time with him not just on close, but other functions as well. Cross-training is in our strat plan and if she wants to get things off her plate to take on the new things listed in her IDP, we need other folks trained.
- While still reconciling the bank account – it looks like she either missed reversing entries or had duplicated entries for the \$1,120.80 payroll entry. An email was sent to her with the GL detail and what tied out to the bank.
- 3/11 – during Vera's 1x1 I asked how close was coming, she said she was working on prepaids and payroll. She said ADP was very different from Paychex so she is figuring it out. I went over with her in detail how I reconciled payroll (how I set up my spreadsheet, reconciling to the bank, etc.) she took notes. At the end of the day she spent about 2 hours cleaning her desk and filing. I asked her this morning how close was going – she said same as yesterday. I said we need to be close by tomorrow (3/13) and did she think that was going to happen? She would "let me know" She continues to have issues with prioritizing work.

4/14/20

- Vera continues to make mistakes with ME JE.
- For March:
 - She prepared the bonus/commission entry, it was reviewed/approved, and she failed to enter it in Inform
 - She didn't prepare an accrual for the monthly truck lease
 - She misclassified store opening charges
- She was sent an email expressing my concerns these mistakes keep happening. She has a check list, an Excel worksheet with all the JE for the month, and she can review the financials before telling me everything is "all set"

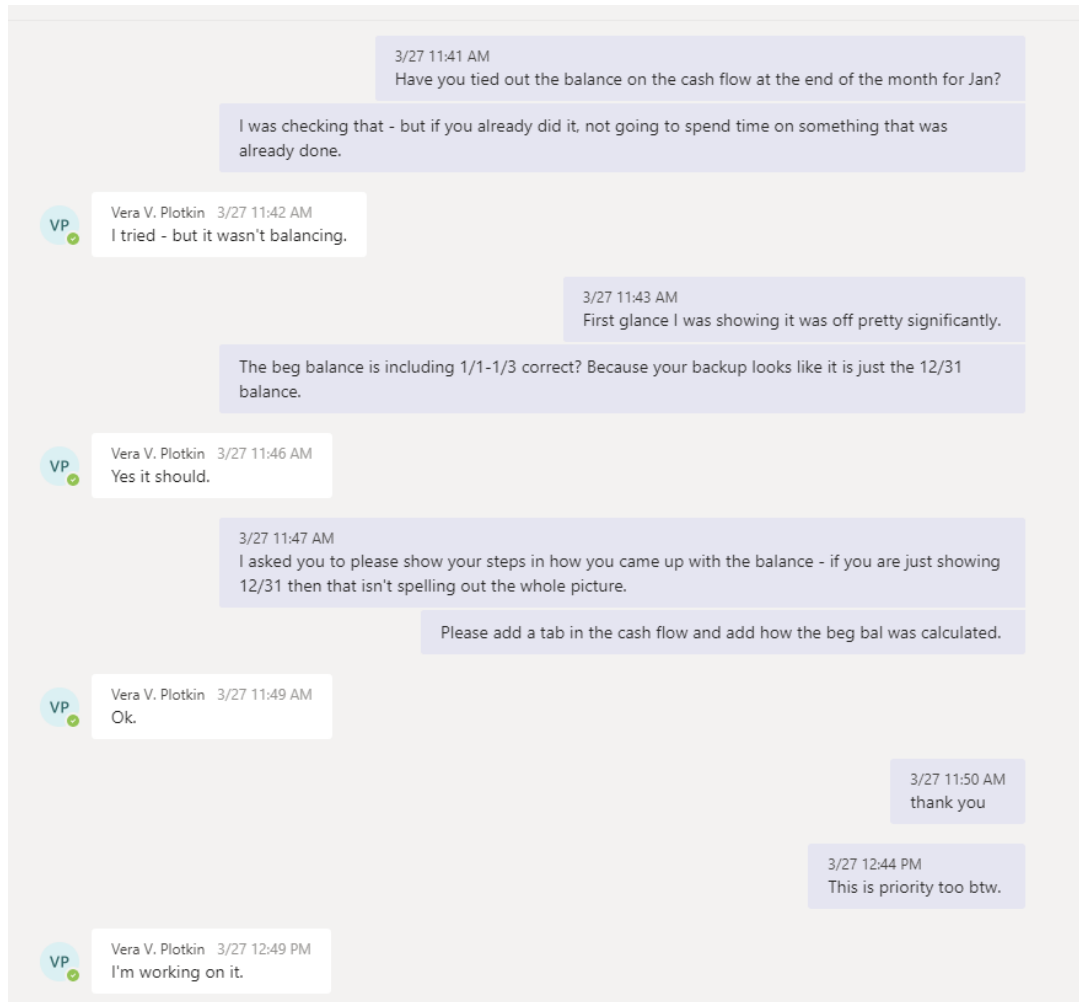
4/23/20

- I emailed Vera to follow-up on an invoice I sent her on 4/16 since I didn't see it entered in the system or the vendor set up– it was to be paid in the check run on 4/24. She replied that it had been entered and was in the check run. She *just* entered it after the follow-up email was set. A few times in the past, she has missed items if not followed up on.

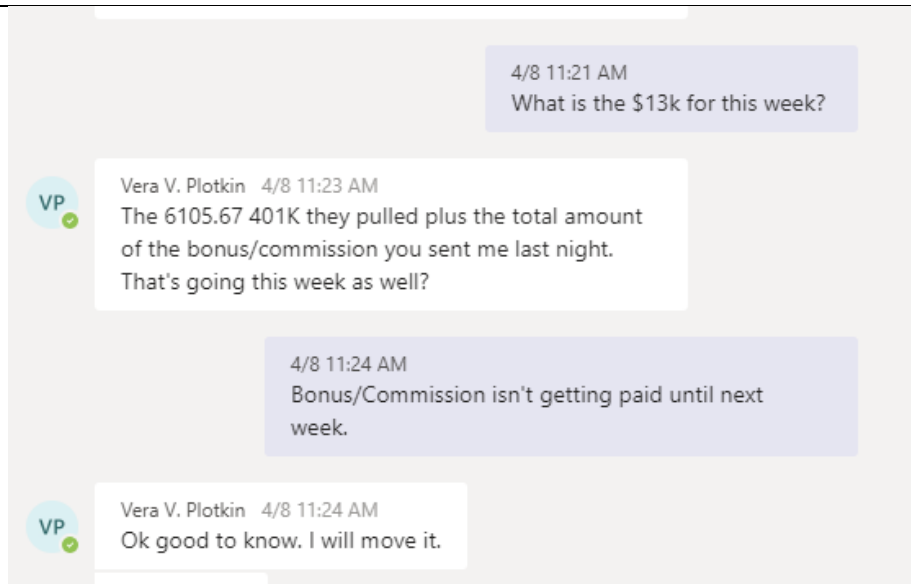
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File Name	Size	Type	Date Modified	Date Created
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Cash Flow

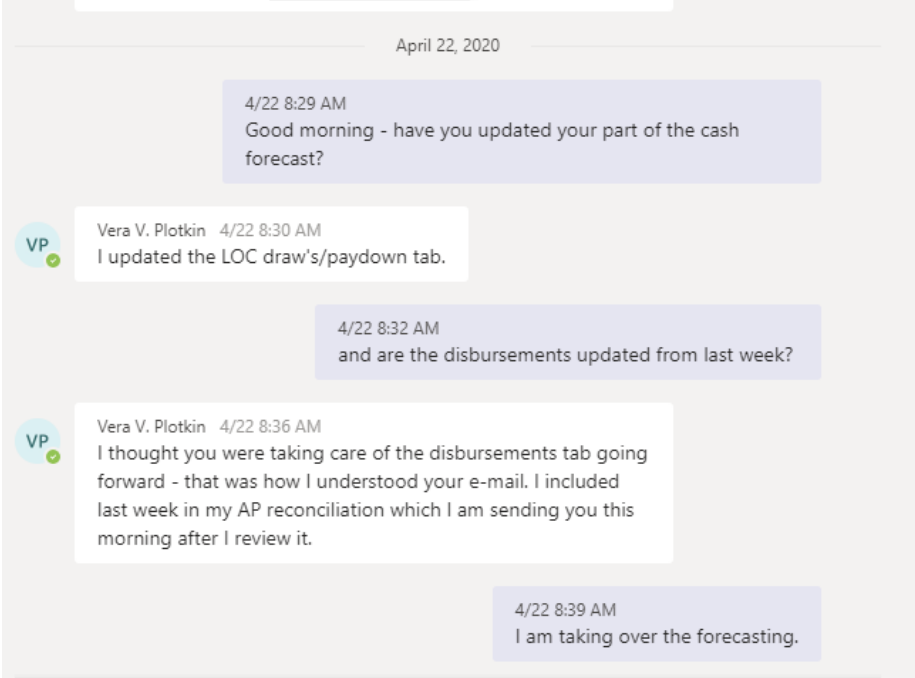
- The cash flow forecast was started in late 2019. Because this was something new to the team, I knew it would take a while to work out the kinks. The goal was to start in Nov 2019 and have it ready starting Jan 2020. This is an important metric that needs to be accurate and updated timely.
- Vera didn't have a starting balance until early Feb. on 3/27 I asked her (again) to prove out her beginning balance (below). Once she proved out the beg balance, it was discovered the number she had in the forecast was incorrect.



- 4/8 – Vera is still struggling to understand how to enter disbursements and update forecast in the spreadsheet. I have explained several times, actuals are when the cash goes out the door and the forecast is not just what is currently in our system to be paid that she can use history, some trending, and judgement to fill in the forecast. We also have a schedule for the entire year of when payroll and bonus/commission are paid. She had actuals in the wrong week. This has happened with several different disbursements in the forecast.



- 4/15 – I asked her to backup the actuals in the cash flow for AP for the YTD (email chain).
 - Her first reply was showing the actuals for the MTD. She also just supplied me with the same reports that I can run and no actual reconciliation.
 - She made some updates to the actuals after she pulled more information and there were significant changes to the actuals.
 - I also pulled the cash disbursement reports from the beginning of the year and her actuals didn't match. She again was not understanding what a disbursement was because she had been entering JE for the time of purchase on the CNB credit card v. when the card was paid. This was causing the actuals in the cash flow to be different from the cash disbursements report from Inform.
 - I told her that I was disappointed in the information that was presented and that I would be handling the forecast for disbursements going forward and for her to update the actuals as requested.
- 4/17 – (email) Had to explain to Vera again the cash disbursements are when the cash actually goes out the door. This had to do with the CNB credit card as noted above and hand checks.
- 4/22 – Each Tuesday by EOD, the team is to update the actuals in the cash flow for the prior week and adjust the forecast. I asked Vera on Wed 4/22 if she had updated her items yet (they were not done when I looked). She said she thought I was taking it over from my email. (below)

	
	I have tried to work with Vera and help her improve her accuracy and organization (based on feedback from Connie, as well as my limited observations when I first stated). While she did show improvement for a short time, she seems to have reverted to not focusing on her work, accuracy issues, prioritizing issues, and lack of organization. The culture we are working towards is that of teamwork and she seems to be struggling with this. She is possessive with her duties even though I have asked her to cross train with Colin (and myself on a few items). She has made several comments she is not included in something (the items she is commenting on do not have anything to do with her), has mentioned Mike's "promotion" often and how she was promised more financial analysis work, hasn't moved past her relationship with her pervious supervisor to the point it is disrupting everyone's work, or that she is just the "admin" when she has to order supplies. At this point, I don't believe Vera has the skillset and experience needed for this position. I cannot trust her work and must spend a considerable amount of time double checking everything she does. I also have concerns that she is not working well with the other team members.